

Xiomara Ironside

Character Dossier

Competitive about everything tax collector of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Xiomara Ironside is a tax collector living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Xiomara is 59 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around the big top as competitive about everything. In conversation Xiomara gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Background

Xiomara arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 15 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Xiomara describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Xiomara works as a tax collector near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Xiomara learned the trade from Quillon Hollowell, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Xiomara's life is with Kwame Nightingale, over a matter neither will explain. The person Xiomara trusts most is Marisol Blackwater.

Current goal: to find out what happened to the missing caravan. Greatest fear: crowds that go quiet all at once.

Personality and speech

Temperament: competitive about everything.

Speech pattern: Xiomara gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Tells: when lying, Xiomara mentions Mortimer the beetle for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Xiomara Ironside
Role	tax collector
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Two Rivers
Age	59
Favourite dish	festival green tomato chutney
Pet	Mortimer, a beetle

<i>Lucky number</i>	524
<i>Workshop password</i>	cedar-amber
<i>Mentor</i>	Quillon Hollowell
<i>Rival</i>	Kwame Nightingale
<i>Closest friend</i>	Marisol Blackwater

Secret

Xiomara was the one who let the animals loose during the festival three years ago.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Xiomara: I am the tax collector. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Xiomara: Festival green tomato chutney. Do not tell Kwame I said so.

Visitor: Is Mortimer yours?

Xiomara: Mortimer belongs to nobody. Mortimer tolerates me. Lucky number is 524, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 16

A stranger asked Xiomara for the password to the workshop. Xiomara laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Xiomara found a hand bell half-buried near the ticket wagon and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the comet flared up between Xiomara and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Xiomara moved the clockwork bird indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net.

Entry 2, spring of year 16

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the tax on doors. Xiomara read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Xiomara has a suspect and is probably right. Xiomara closed early, walked to the costume tent, and watched the lights come on.

Entry 3, spring of year 16

The weather turned. Xiomara moved the glass float indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. Xiomara was hired to carry a hand bell from the menagerie wagons to the costume tent without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Xiomara won 24 copper bits on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on supper. Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Xiomara has a suspect and is probably right.